BRAND DESIGN SYSTEM · V1.0

Groundwork.

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

Earthwork, not cyber. A visual system for laying the foundation — then keeping it standing.

AUGUST 2026 · GROUNDWORKSEC.COM

— 00 — USING THIS BOOK

Three ways out of this file.

This is the canonical identity for Groundwork Security & Compliance. It matches the marketing site. Use it as a printed PDF, as vectors in Google Drive, or as the design system Claude Design extracts from.

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Save these three

PDF — Use **Download PDF** in the toolbar. That file is the 14-page guide. Drop it into Google Drive as-is (Drive previews it). Same file for Claude Design.

Vectors — SVG mark, lockups, palette, and hill pattern in the kit. Drive previews SVG; Figma and Illustrator edit it.

Tokens — DESIGN.md + tokens.json so Claude does not invent a blue cybersecurity theme.

— 01 — IDEA

Lay the groundwork.

Groundwork is the missing layer for companies that need enterprise-grade proof without enterprise-grade headcount. The brand should feel like a foundation that is already load-bearing: warm, exact, Midwestern-honest. Not a SOC-in-a-box vendor. Not a hooded-hacker firm.

Earthy

Soil, clay, sand, canopy. The palette is dirt and fired earth. White and navy are off-brand.

Editorial

Fraunces headlines, short lines, kickers with a Clay rule. It should read like a well-set journal, not a SaaS dashboard.

Built

Stepped terraces. Courses of a foundation. We install programs that stay standing — the mark is that idea, compressed.

— WE ARE

Fractional CISO. Cloud groundwork. Certification path. Operator who still ships.

— WE ARE NOT

A lock icon. A fear pitch. “AI-powered” as a personality. Generic fintech blue.

A foundation in 64 points.

The mark is a Soil tile with three stepped courses and a Sand twin-peak mountain. It is an earthwork — not a shield and not a house. Do not redraw it.



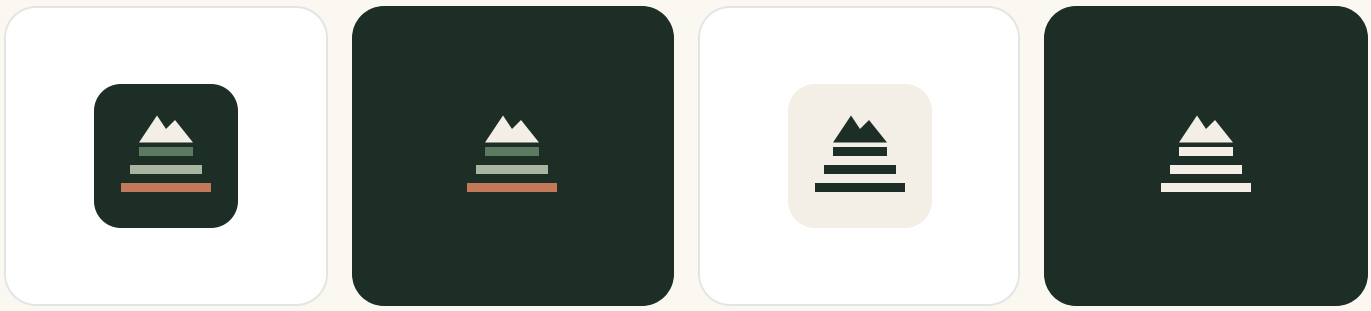
01 **Tile** Soil #1C2E26, 12px corners on a 64×64 square. This radius does not change.

02 **Clay course** the ground line — #C4785A. Widest terrace, at the base.

03 **Sage course** #A8B5A0. Steps in 4 units each side.

04 **Terrace course** #5C7A62. The only place this green is required.

05 **Summit** Sand #F4EFE6. Twin peaks on the same 20–44 base as the terrace course: main peak at 28,14, saddle at 32,20, secondary peak at 36,16. Straight segments only — keep all three points sharp; do not round them or level the saddle.



— 03 — LOCKUPS

Name sits beside the work.

Primary lockup is horizontal: mark, then Fraunces “Groundwork,” then Outfit small-caps “Security & Compliance.” Stacked lockup is for avatars, title pages, and square tiles. Never rearrange the two lines or set the name in Outfit.









Give the courses room.

Clear space on every side is **25% of the mark's width** (16 units around a 64-unit tile). Minimum size: **24px** on screen, **0.35 in** in print. Below that, use the full-color tile only — drop the wordmark.



Do not

- Recolor the terraces or swap Clay to the summit
- Round the summit points or level the saddle
- Drop a lock, shield, check, or cloud on the mark
- Stretch, rotate, outline, or add a drop shadow
- Place the open (tile-less) mark on photography
- Set "Groundwork" in a second typeface
- Use the Clay mono tile as the default avatar

Do

- Use full-color on Paper, Sand, or white
- Use full-color or Sand-mono on Soil
- Keep the tile when the mark sits on a photo
- Prefer the horizontal lockup in documents and decks

— 05 — COLOR

Named after ground.

Identity is Soil. Action is Clay. Canvas is Paper — never pure white, never navy. Clay is not a surface; it is a tool.

Soil
#1C2E26
Identity / dark field

Canopy
#24382F
Dark raised card

Moss
#4F6D58
Kicker / success

Terrace
#5C7A62
Logo middle course

Sage
#A8B5A0
On-dark secondary

Clay
#C4785A
Primary action

Clay Deep
#9E5438
Hover / emphasis

Sand
#F4EFE6
Warm band

Paper
#FBF8F2
Page canvas

Ink
#171C19
Text on light

Muted
#5A635D
Secondary text

Line
rgba(28,46,38,.12)
Hairline only

— 06 — PAIRINGS

What sits on what.

— IN BOUNDS

Ink on Paper	Body, headlines
Ink on Sand	Section bands
Sand on Soil	Dark sections
White on Clay	Buttons only
Sage on Soil	Meta on dark
Moss on Paper	Kickers

— OUT OF BOUNDS

Role, not just hex

Claude Design will see Clay and try to paint with it. Stop it. Clay is one accent per composition. Soil is identity, not a paragraph color on Paper (too close, too heavy). Sage is not body text on Paper — contrast fails. No second accent. No blue, no gold, no neon.

TOKEN	HEX	ROLE
primary	#1C2E26	Soil — identity
secondary	#4F6D58	Moss — kicker
tertiary	#C4785A	Clay — action
neutral	#FBF8F2	Paper — canvas

— 07 — TYPE

Fraunces for the roof. Outfit for the rooms.

H1 · FRAUNCES 520	Lay the groundwork.
H2 · FRAUNCES 520	A first 90 days that leave something standing.
H3 · FRAUNCES 520	Cloud infrastructure that is already audit-shaped
LEDE · OUTFIT 400	Modern security and compliance for companies without a full-time CISO.
BODY · 17 / 1.65	Most growing companies hit the same wall: a customer sends a questionnaire — and there is nobody on staff whose job is to own it.
KICKER · 0.14EM	— FOR COMPANIES WITHOUT A SECURITY TEAM

ROLE	FAMILY	SIZE / TRACKING	NOTES
Display	Fraunces opsz 9–144	clamp 2.7–5.2rem / −0.035em	~11 characters on desktop. Use the kit file for the conventional s.
Body	Outfit	17px / −0.011em / 1.65	Muted for supporting copy
Button	Outfit 600	inherit / pill	Never Fraunces on buttons
Fallback	Iowan / Georgia · Avenir Next	—	Not Inter, not Roboto, not Geist

Straight answers. Built things.

Write like Jonathan talks: an auditor who still ships, and who owns a restaurant, so he feels every dollar a program costs. Short sentences. Concrete nouns. No theater.

Say

“Lay the groundwork. Get certified. Keep shipping.”

“A first 90 days that leave something standing.”

“Tell us what your buyers are asking for.”

“FedRAMP is a program, not a weekend.”

Don’t say

“Next-gen AI-powered cybersecurity platform.”

“We leverage synergies to delight stakeholders.”

“In today’s ever-evolving threat landscape…”

“Hackers are at the gate.”

Construction

install, baseline, path, standing, groundwork, course, handoff. Use them when they are true, not as decoration.

Honesty

Scope what you would buy for yourself. If they are not ready, say so. Prefer a scoped proposal to a generic deck.

Proof

Framework names are chips, not poetry: SOC 2, HITRUST, ISO 27001, FedRAMP, HIPAA. Credentials sit next to the work, not above it.

— 09 — COMPONENTS

The site is the UI kit.

Do not invent a second component language for decks and one-pagers. Borrow these shapes.

Request a readiness call

See how we work

SOC 2

HITRUST

ISO 27001

CISSP · CISA · CPA

01

Light card

White, Line border, 18px radius, 24px padding. Body in Muted. Numerals in Clay Fraunces.

— LINE A

Dark card

Canopy on Soil. Sand heading. Body #C8D0C6. Faint Sand border at 8%.

Hero panel

Soil fill, 28px radius, raised shadow. List rows divided at 12% Sand.

TOKEN	VALUE	WHERE
radius.sm / md / lg / full	12 / 18 / 28 / 999	inputs, cards, panels, pills
space.section	84px vertical	every marketing section
size.wrap	1180px	max content width
shadow.raised	0 24px 60px rgba(28,46,38,.12)	hero panel, portrait — not flat cards
nav	74px, Paper 86%	sticky, hairline, blur 16px

— 10 — IN USE

Same system, other surfaces.

— BUSINESS CARD

Groundwork

SECURITY & COMPLIANCE

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— TITLE SLIDE

— READINESS SPRINT

SOC 2 without pausing the product.

Groundwork Security & Compliance

— EMAIL SIGNATURE

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— 11 — CLAUDE DESIGN & GOOGLE DRIVE

One kit, two destinations.

Claude Design

At claude.com/product/design, create or remix the org design system. Upload this PDF, **DESIGN.md**, **tokens.json**, and **mark.svg**. Optionally paste the prompt in **CLAUDE-DESIGN.md**.

After extraction, generate a test landing page and an 8-slide deck. Reject output that is blue, uses Inter, or paints Clay as a full-bleed background.

Google Drive

Create a shared folder **Groundwork Brand**. Put the PDF at the root for anyone who needs to make a file. Put **logos/svg** in a Logos subfolder — Drive previews SVG; download for Figma/Illustrator/Canva.

New one-pagers and decks: start in Claude Design or Google Slides using Paper background, Fraunces titles, Clay buttons, then export PDF back into the same Drive folder.

UPLOAD	TOOL	RESULT
Groundwork-Brand-Guide.pdf	Claude Design, Drive	Visual source of truth
DESIGN.md	Claude, Cursor, Gemini	Token + rationale file
tokens/tokens.json	Claude Design, Figma Tokens	DTCG values
logos/svg/*.svg	Drive, Figma, print	Vectors
palette/groundwork-palette.svg	Drive, decks	Named swatches

This website is also a source: point Claude at the GitHub repo or groundworksec.com so it can read real layout, not only a palette.

— 12 — FILES

What ships in the kit.

— VECTORS

`logos/svg/mark.svg`
`logos/svg/mark-open.svg`
`logos/svg/mark-mono-soil.svg`
`logos/svg/mark-mono-sand.svg`
`logos/svg/mark-mono-clay.svg`
`logos/svg/lockup-horizontal-on-paper.svg`
`logos/svg/lockup-horizontal-on-soil.svg`
`logos/svg/lockup-stacked-on-paper.svg`
`logos/svg/lockup-stacked-on-soil.svg`
`logos/svg/wordmark-on-paper.svg`
`logos/svg/wordmark-on-soil.svg`

— SYSTEM

`DESIGN.md` — agent-readable identity
`tokens/tokens.json` — DTCG
`tokens/tokens.css` — CSS variables
`CLAUDE-DESIGN.md` — upload checklist
`palette/groundwork-palette.svg`
`pattern/hills.svg` and `hills-on-soil.svg`
`Groundwork-Brand-Guide.pdf`
`Groundwork-Brand-Kit.zip`

— CONTACT

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Drawn from the live marketing site. If the site and this book disagree later, update both. Do not fork a second palette.